

Plumbing Leak Homeowner Guide — Action Checklist

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CLASSIFY YOUR LEAK TYPE

- ☐ **Classify Your Leak Type:** Identify whether water is seeping slowly, dripping actively, spraying under pressure, hidden behind walls, or seeping through your foundation to determine the urgency level.
- ☐ **Classify Your Leak Type:** Watch for hidden leak signs including musty odors, discoloration or bubbling paint, soft drywall spots, warped baseboards, or unexplained spikes in your water bill.
- ☐ **Classify Your Leak Type:** Check for slab leak indicators such as warm spots on floors, water sounds beneath the slab, foundation cracks, or moisture appearing around room edges.
- ☐ **Classify Your Leak Type:** Recognize that slow seeps and active drips have low to medium urgency and may be DIY candidates if the connection point is accessible and you've identified the faulty component.

LOCATE SHUT-OFF VALVES

- ☐ **Locate Shut-Off Valves:** Find your main water shut-off valve where the service line enters your home, typically near the water meter, in the basement, utility room, or mechanical room.
- ☐ **Locate Shut-Off Valves:** Test your main shut-off valve once yearly by turning it off and back on—if it feels stiff or won't close completely, have it serviced before an emergency.
- ☐ **Locate Shut-Off Valves:** Know the difference between a gate valve with a round wheel that closes clockwise and a ball valve with a lever that requires a 90-degree quarter-turn.
- ☐ **Locate Shut-Off Valves:** Locate individual shut-off valves under sinks and behind toilets on supply lines so you can isolate one fixture without shutting off water to the entire house.

MAKE REPAIR DECISIONS

- ☐ **Make Repair Decisions:** Call a plumber immediately for pressure leaks since the spray force can cause serious injury and the water volume can cause rapid damage—you cannot manage this yourself.
 - ☐ **Make Repair Decisions:** Call a professional for hidden and slab leaks since the repair requires specialized detection equipment and the pipes are not directly accessible for patching.
 - ☐ **Make Repair Decisions:** Attempt DIY repairs only when the leak source is accessible, you've identified the faulty component like a washer or O-ring, and you have proper tools available.
 - ☐ **Make Repair Decisions:** If you're unsure about fixing a slow seep or active drip, call a plumber for an estimate rather than risk a repair that fails and causes water damage.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.